

This section provides rules for using terrain to transform your gaming table into an interactive, thematic battlefield. These rules help to bring your battlefield to life and introduce a vital tactical dimension to your games.

PLACING TERRAIN 13.01

Before the battle, place a selection of **terrain features** on the battlefield using one or more of the following methods:

- Place a well-defined boundary (such as a base or mat) in each location you want to furnish with terrain, then place one or more **terrain features** wholly within that boundary.
- Place one **terrain feature** directly on the battlefield.
- Place two or more **terrain features** directly on the battlefield in such a way that together they define the boundary of an area.

In each case, the area of the battlefield occupied by that boundary or **terrain feature** is known as a **terrain area**. A mission's deployment map may define the location and dimensions of each **terrain area**. Otherwise, players must agree on this before the battle.

CREATING YOUR OWN BATTLEFIELD

*Don't worry if your battlefield doesn't match a mission's **terrain category** requirements; just do the best with the **terrain features** you have. If a mission does not provide you with guidance, it will be up to the players to decide how to create their battlefield. When doing so, keep in mind that **dense terrain features** have the greatest impact on visibility and movement. Battlefields with too few **dense terrain features** can advantage armies that rely on shooting, or disadvantage armies that rely on melee. Also remember to leave sufficient room around **dense terrain features** for larger models such as **MONSTERS/VEHICLES** to manoeuvre, especially near the edges of the battlefield.*

TERRAIN CATEGORIES 13.02

Each **terrain feature** belongs to a **terrain category**, which can affect the movement and visibility of models. Below are some examples of which types of **terrain features** fall under each category.

EXPOSED 13.03

Exposed terrain offers only scant protection to the most desperate troops, and can be traversed without hindrance.

Examples: Craters, razorwire, scattered debris.

LIGHT 13.04

Light terrain can provide cover from incoming attacks, but will not slow an enemy's advance or offer lasting defence.

Examples: Barricades, low walls, statuary.

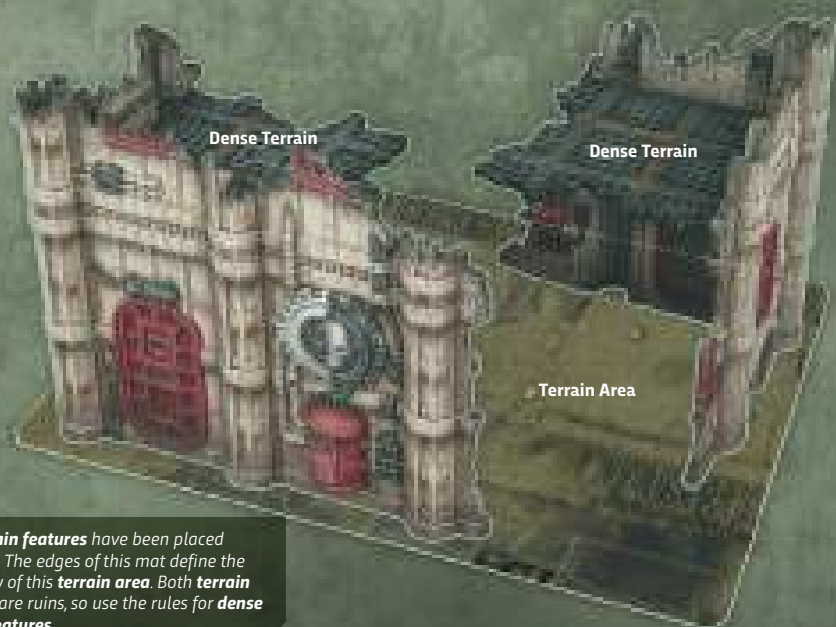
DENSE 13.05

Dense terrain is an obstacle to even the largest war machines, and can shelter entire squads from enemy sight.

Examples: Buildings, ruins, armoured containers, woods.

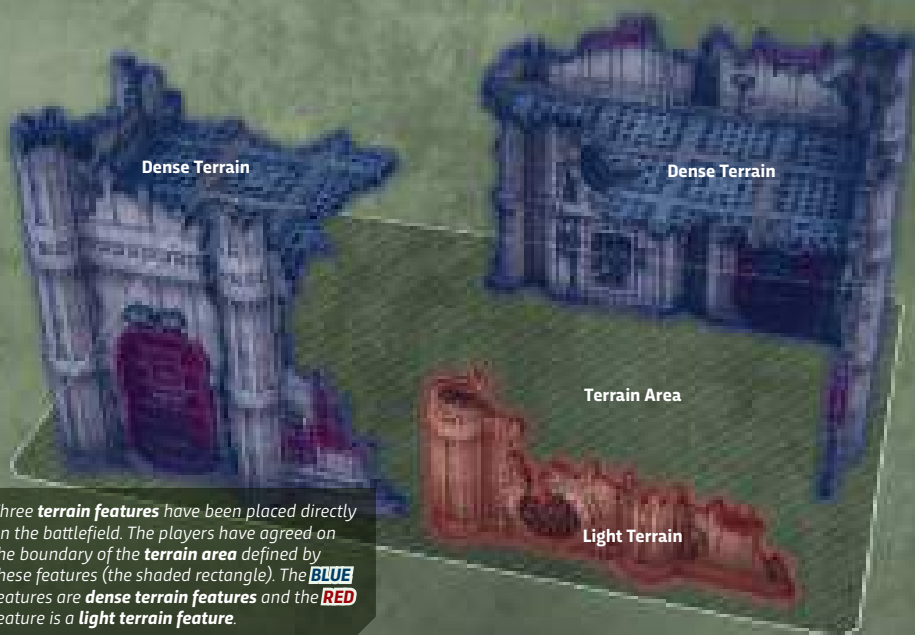
A mission's deployment map may define which **terrain categories** should be present within each **terrain area**. Meeting these requirements will create the best gaming experience. Note that **terrain features** sharing the same **terrain area** can belong to different **terrain categories**.

TERRAIN PLACED ON A MAT



Two **terrain features** have been placed on a mat. The edges of this mat define the boundary of this **terrain area**. Both **terrain features** are ruins, so use the rules for **dense terrain features**.

TERRAIN PLACED ON THE BATTLEFIELD



Three **terrain features** have been placed directly on the battlefield. The players have agreed on the boundary of the **terrain area** defined by these features (the shaded rectangle). The **BLUE** features are **dense terrain features** and the **RED** feature is a **light terrain feature**.



TERRAIN AND MOVEMENT ^{13.06}

Models can move through different categories of **terrain feature** as follows:

- **Exposed/Light:** All models can move horizontally and vertically through **exposed** and **light terrain features**.
- **Dense:**
 - **INFANTRY/BEASTS/SWARM/MOBILE** models can move horizontally through **dense terrain features**.
 - **INFANTRY/BEASTS/SWARM** models can move vertically through **dense terrain features**.
 - Other models can move horizontally through **dense terrain features** provided that all sections of that **terrain feature** that the moving model's base would move through are 2" or less in height. Otherwise, the moving model must move vertically to ascend or descend such sections. They cannot move through ceilings and floors while doing so, and they cannot end that move on any surface of that **terrain feature** that is not on ground level (see below).

PLUNGING FIRE

*As well as gaining superior lines of sight, models that ascend tall **terrain features** can benefit from the **Plunging Fire** rule (22.05).*

SOLID TERRAIN

*If a **terrain feature** has the **Solid** rule (13.11), as **dense terrain features** do, a model cannot end a move such that any part of it is through any enclosed part of that **terrain feature** that is 3" or less from ground level – not even through small openings such as doors and windows. This ensures that protruding elements of models cannot be used to circumvent the visibility restrictions of the **Solid** rule.*

MOVING VERTICALLY

Models can move vertically to ascend or descend **terrain features**. While doing so:

- That model must remain within $\frac{1}{2}$ " horizontally of that **terrain feature**.
- Add the distance moved vertically up, and the distance moved vertically down, to any other distance that model has moved since its unit began that move.

SETTING UP OR ENDING A MOVE

Models can be set up or end a move on the ground level of **terrain features**. Models can also be set up or end a move on any surface of a **terrain feature** that is not on ground level, if all of the following apply:

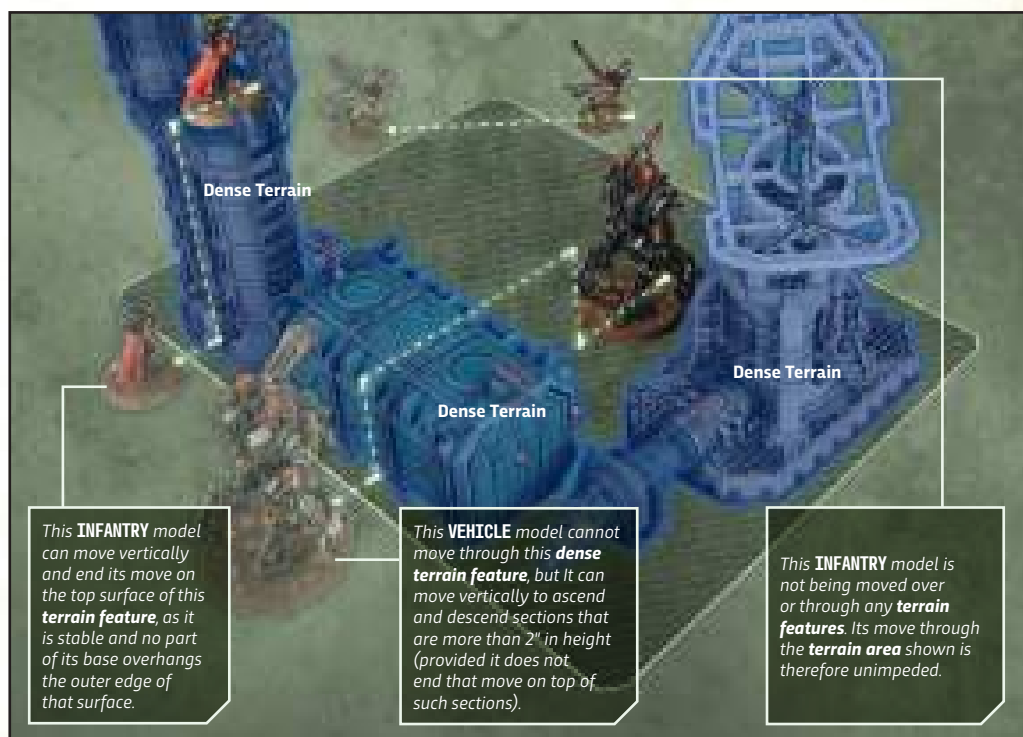
- That model has one or more of the following keywords: **INFANTRY/BEASTS/SWARM/FLY/MONSTER**.
- After ending that move, that model is stable and no part of its base overhangs the outer edge of that surface.

TERRAIN AND MOVEMENT



All sections of this **dense terrain feature** are more than 2" in height, so this **MONSTER** model cannot move through it and must move around it instead.

These **INFANTRY** models can move through **dense terrain features**, such as the walls of this ruin.



This **INFANTRY** model can move vertically and end its move on the top surface of this **terrain feature**, as it is stable and no part of its base overhangs the outer edge of that surface.

This **VEHICLE** model cannot move through this **dense terrain feature**, but it can move vertically to ascend and descend sections that are more than 2" in height (provided it does not end that move on top of such sections).

This **INFANTRY** model is not being moved over or through any **terrain features**. Its move through the **terrain area** shown is therefore unimpeded.





TERRAIN AND VISIBILITY 13.07

Terrain can affect visibility, depending on whether the **Benefit of Cover**, **Hidden**, **Obscuring** or **Solid** rules apply.

BENEFIT OF COVER 13.08

Each time a ranged attack targets a unit, if every model in that unit meets one or more of the following conditions, that unit has the **benefit of cover** against that attack:

- That model has the **INFANTRY/BEASTS/SWARM** keyword and is within a **terrain area**.
- That model is not **fully visible** to the attacking model due to one or more intervening **terrain features** and/or one or more intervening **obscuring terrain areas** (see below).

Each time a ranged attack targets a unit that has the **benefit of cover** against it, worsen the **BS** characteristic of that attack by 1.

HIDDEN 13.09

A model is **hidden** while all of the following apply to it:

- That model has the **INFANTRY/BEASTS/SWARM** keyword and is within a **terrain area** that contains one or more **dense terrain features**.
- That model's unit did not make one or more ranged attacks during this turn or during the previous turn.

While a model is **hidden**, it can only be **visible** to enemy models that are within its **detection range**. Unless otherwise stated, a model's **detection range** is 15".

OBSCURING 13.10

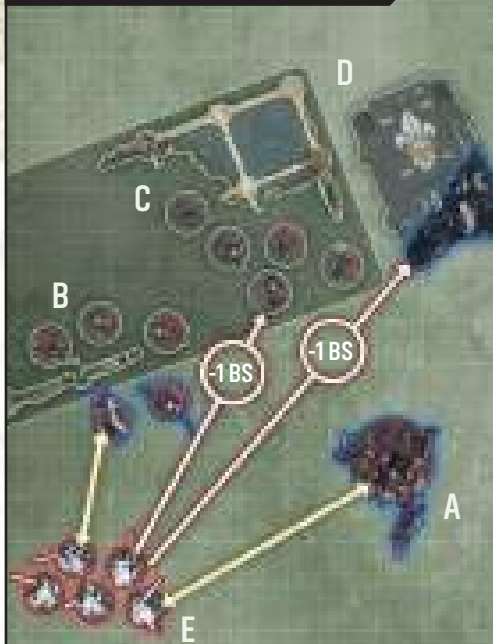
Terrain areas containing one or more **light** or **dense terrain features** are **obscuring terrain areas**. If every **line of sight** drawn between two models crosses one or more **obscuring terrain areas** (excluding **obscuring terrain areas** that one or both of those models are within), those two models are not **visible** to each other.

SOLID 13.11

Dense terrain features have the **Solid** rule. **Line of sight** cannot be drawn across any enclosed gap in the surface of such a **terrain feature** that is 3" or less from ground level.

Designer's Note: This rule ensures that models are not **visible** while sheltering in ground-level terrain, irrespective of small openings such as doors, windows or bullet holes, or because of small gaps between adjacent **terrain features**. 3" is the height of the first floor of many **terrain features**, but some missions may adjust the height at which this rule takes effect.

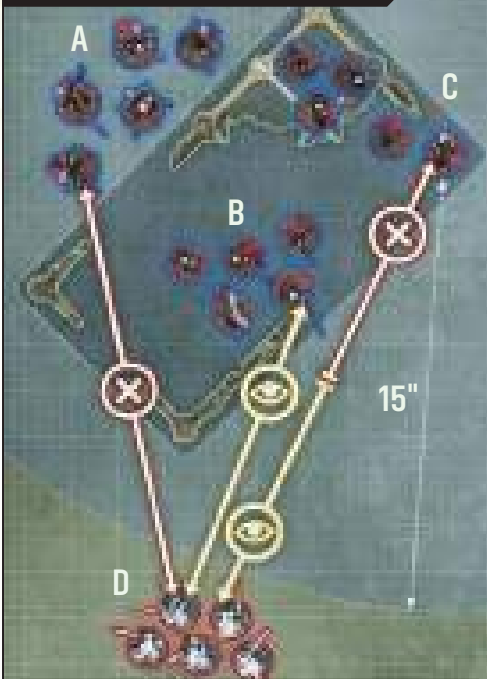
BENEFIT OF COVER



When Unit **E** makes ranged attacks:

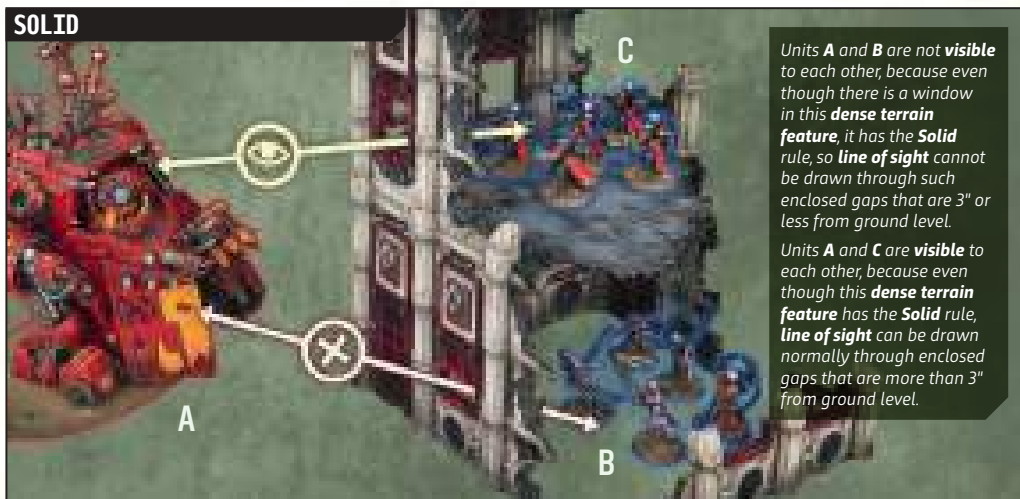
- Unit **A** is **fully visible** to every model in Unit **E**, so does not have the **benefit of cover**.
- Not all of the models in unit **B** are within a **terrain area**, so unit **B** does not have the **benefit of cover**.
- All of the models in unit **C** are within a **terrain area**, so unit **C** has the **benefit of cover**.
- Unit **D** is not **fully visible** to unit **E** due to an intervening **obscuring terrain area**, so unit **D** has the **benefit of cover**.

HIDDEN AND OBSCURING



- There is an **obscuring terrain area** between all models in units **A** and **D**, so none of them are **visible** to each other.
- All models in units **B** and **C** are within the **terrain area** and are **INFANTRY**, so are **hidden**. However, unit **D**'s models are within the 15" **detection range** of unit **B**'s models (but not unit **C**'s), so unit **B**'s models are **visible** to unit **D**'s. Unit **D**'s models are also **visible** to the models in units **B** and **C**, since they are not within a **terrain area**.

SOLID



Units **A** and **B** are not **visible** to each other, because even though there is a window in this **dense terrain feature**, it has the **Solid** rule, so **line of sight** cannot be drawn through such enclosed gaps that are 3" or less from ground level.

Units **A** and **C** are **visible** to each other, because even though this **dense terrain feature** has the **Solid** rule, **line of sight** can be drawn normally through enclosed gaps that are more than 3" from ground level.